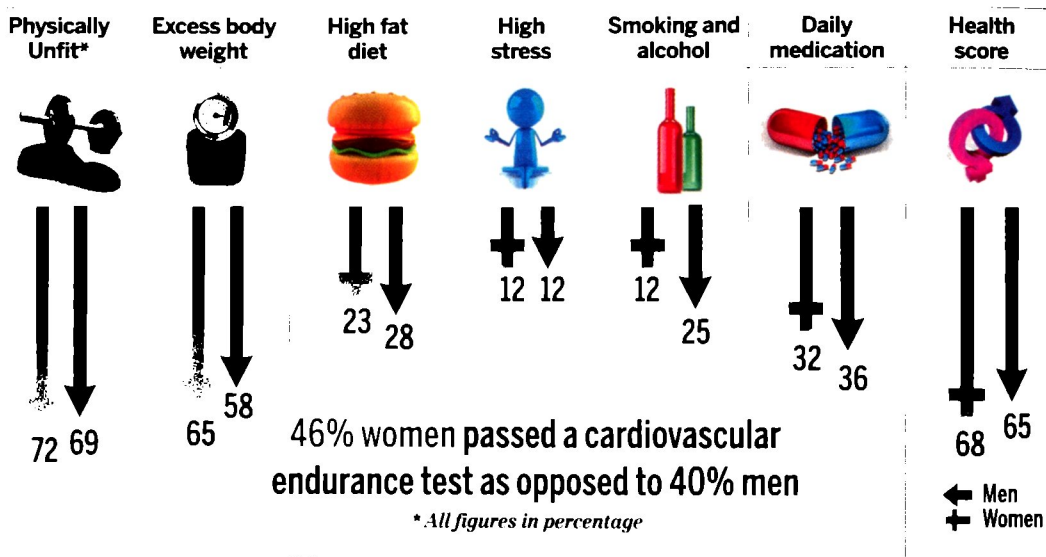


A Nation of Healthier Women

Indian women have better lifestyles and score higher than men on the health front, says a survey

The wellness unit of Apollo Hospitals tested 47,755 men and women between 2005-09. The maze of statistics reveals:

- Women have a better diet, while men smoke and drink away their advantage.
- Men might be in better shape, but are more susceptible to troubling health issues and major lifestyle ailments.



Food Issue

The Indian woman has better food habits than her male counterpart in the study: 69 per cent had fruits and salads daily vis-a-vis 65 per cent of men. More men had a high fat diet (28 per cent vs 23 per cent of women), indulged in sweets (24 per cent vs 20 per cent of women); snacked frequently (20 vs 16 per cent) and ate out much more (20 vs 8 per cent).

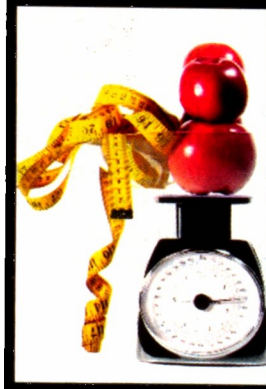


BATTLE OF THE SEXES



Men appear to face more troubling health issues: diabetes (16 per cent), high blood pressure (11 per cent) and high cholesterol (7 per cent). Women, on the contrary, seem to suffer more from annoying everyday afflictions—headaches (23 per cent), asthma (7 per cent), indigestion (31 per cent), joint pain (39 per cent), skin trouble (11 per cent) and allergies (11 per cent).

The height of the average Indian male is 5'6", while that of the female is 5'1". Males weigh an average of 73 kg while women average 64 kg.



Lifestyle Woes



Both cancer and heart ailments are multifactorial and caused by inappropriate lifestyle—including obesity, a high fat diet, lack of exercise, stress, smoking etc. Urban Indian men, though more fit than women, unfortunately smoke and drink much more. No wonder, 56 per cent of men are more at risk of heart attacks than women (50 per cent). While 9 per cent of men face cancer risk, only 3 per cent of women do so.

■ Compiled by Damayanti Datta